esteemed

The **AI+Human** platform for work

An invitation to owner-operators — build something bigger, together.

AI is reshaping staffing. You don't have to sell to survive it — you can transform.

You feel it, and it's been building for years now. AI is compressing margins, automating the front of the funnel, and changing what clients expect. **There's a third option — a strategic merger with a tech-enabled platform that transforms your business instead of liquidating it.**

You've built something real — clients, revenue, reputation. That's the hard part. On its own, though, it sells the way agencies always sell: a few times EBITDA, illiquid, dependent on you, never a software valuation. The merger changes what it can become. **In the M&A world this is also sometimes called a second bite of the apple.**

> **Did you know that if you merged into a software platform, a good portion of your revenue could shift onto the platform — recurring, subscription, software — driving a major boost in valuation?**

Here's why that matters. A staffing agency sells for 4–8× **EBITDA**. A tech-enabled platform sells for 7–19× **revenue**. You don't have to move all of it — as more of your revenue becomes platform revenue, the blended valuation climbs toward the software end. On $100M of revenue, the gap between the two worlds is roughly **$80M as a pure agency versus several times that as a platform**.

But let's be straight: that re-rating isn't a relabeling trick. **It requires the business to actually change** — not dramatically, but genuinely. The work that can be productized becomes recurring, subscription, and software revenue; the work that can't stays solid, tech-enabled staffing revenue. You don't fake the multiple. You earn it by building the recurring layer — and that's exactly what our platform is built to help you do.

THIS ISN'T THEORY — HERE ARE THE REAL NUMBERS

Platforms that bundle human talent into software get valued like software. Superside raised at **~21× revenue**; Remote, a workforce platform closer to our model, at ~7.6×; and Fiverr acquired Stoke Talent for $95M — more than double its prior valuation, on modest revenue:

Platform	Year	Revenue	Valuation	Multiple
Superside	2022	$25M	$530M	**~21×**
Remote	2018	~$10M	~$76M	**~7.6×**
Stoke Talent	2021	modest	$95M	acq.

Superside and Remote are private-round valuations; Stoke was an acquisition. We anchor conservatively to Remote's ~7.6× — a workforce platform like ours — and build toward the higher end as our software and AI revenue matures.

THE CATCH — AND WHY IT'S SOLVED

Building that platform takes years and millions most owners will never spend. **Ours is already built and live:**

- **Esteemed Intelligence** — our AI company-brain, live today, woven through delivery.
- **Colleagues** — our talent marketplace, live and already booking revenue (member tiers expand next quarter).
- **HCMGPT** — our AI front door for hiring and workforce operations, launching now.

You don't build it. You **merge with it**. This is the valuation arbitrage: your traditional staffing — talent acquisition, procurement, workforce management — gets transformed into subscription and platform-enabled delivery on the Colleagues marketplace, then we cross-sell hosting, AI, and SaaS into your customer base. Transactional revenue becomes recurring revenue, and recurring revenue earns a higher multiple. The mix moves up, and the valuation moves with it.

THE PEOPLE BEHIND IT

Chris McGrath, Founder & CEO, has spent 25 years in talent marketplaces and staffing — founding and scaling Esteemed on a platform he first built in 2011, and personally architecting and building the platform and AI coherence engine the company runs on today. Former AT&T (Hypergrowth) and Accenture (Digital).

Tom Schmidt, Co-Founder & Chief Strategy Officer, spent 30 years inside this industry — former SVP at Recruit Holdings, the **$23.3B** global staffing and HR-tech leader (Indeed, Glassdoor), and a senior leader at ManpowerGroup. He founded Pathfinder Advisory to scale staffing businesses.

And this is exactly the move we made ourselves. Chris founded and scaled the platform and the AI; after testing the roll-up thesis himself, he partnered with Tom in 2025 as the deliberate management augment to reach the goal. Two operators who each could have built something smaller alone — combined, on purpose, into Esteemed. We're not pitching a theory. We're inviting you into the same move that built us.

THE AMBITION — WHERE THIS GOES

Three partners a year. Five years. A platform worth billions.

We target roughly three partner firms a year. Each starts at about **70% recurring staffing revenue and 30% software** — and we work that mix richer over time by converting staffing onto the marketplace and cross-selling hosting, AI, and SaaS. Compounded over five years, from today's base, that looks like this:

If partners are…	Year-5 revenue	Year-5 platform value
Smaller (~$10M each)	**~$175M**	**~$1.0B**
Mid-size (~$25M each)	**~$435M**	**~$2.5B**
Larger (~$40M each)	**~$700M**	**~$3.9B**

The range depends on the size of the firms we partner with — we can't know that in advance, so we show all three. Valued on the blend: software revenue at software multiples, recurring staffing at a premium to any transactional agency. **At that scale, the choice becomes ours: go public, or keep compounding.**

THE OFFER, PLAINLY

Merge in. Keep running the business you're great at — now powered by our platform and Tom's growth engine — and take **equity in the larger, software-valued platform**. Your liquidity comes at the platform's exit or funding event, priced on the platform's multiple, not your old agency multiple. A meaningful share of something big and rising beats all of something capped — and the earlier you're in, the more of that curve you own.

Let's talk.

If you'd rather own a piece of the next Adecco-meets-Amazon than keep grinding under the agency ceiling alone, let's have the conversation.

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Trajectory and valuation figures are illustrative, built on stated assumptions (≈3 partner firms/year at $10–40M revenue each; a revenue mix that begins near 70% recurring staffing / 30% software and shifts toward software over time via cross-sell; software revenue valued at conservative software multiples and recurring staffing at a premium to transactional agencies). They are targets and illustrations of the model — not projections or guarantees. Comparable outcomes (Stoke Talent, Superside) reflect other companies. Any combination would be subject to mutual diligence and definitive documentation.